

Daily Need to Know

Wednesday, 23 September 2026 · Pre-market brief

Coverage window, capture method and edition notes are at the back, in section 16.

1 Market snapshot — the close, and where it is trading now

ASSET	LAST	CHANGE	NOTE
US CASH EQUITIES & VOLATILITY — SETTLED 16:00 ET TUE 22 SEP = 04:00 GMT+8, 5H 11M OLD			
S&P 500	7,764.64	▼ 0.06 -0.01%	Range 7,756-7,782 , just 0.33% wide — the narrowest of the five. Closed in the bottom third of it, 0.67% below the 52-week high of 7,816.70. Not a record, whatever the Nasdaq did.
Nasdaq Composite	27,244.28	▲ 122.18 +0.45%	High of 27,288.79 is a new 52-week high; closed 0.16% under it, at 65% of the day's range. Record intraday and record close.
Dow Jones Industrial	51,863.69	▼ 185.14 -0.36%	Opened at 52,301.92, within 17 points of the day's high, and closed 438 points lower , at 23% of a 593-point range. The one index that reversed outright. 5.26% below its 52-week high.
Russell 2000	2,889.92	▲ 14.56 +0.51%	Closed mid-range. Still 5.86% below its 52-week high — the bounce has not repaired the small-cap drawdown Hedgeye keeps pointing at.
Philadelphia SOX	12,689.82	▲ 256.65 +2.06%	Opened on the low and closed at 95% of a 3.00% range — the cleanest trend day on the board. Still 13.41% below its 52-week high.
VIX	14.22	▼ 0.64 -4.31%	Closed at 3.9% of the day's range , i.e. on the low, and below the floor of Hedgeye's 14.24-17.85 band. 52-week low is 13.38.
US INDEX FUTURES — LIVE, CAPTURED 09:10:50 GMT+8, ~10-MIN DELAYED FEED; GLOBEX REOPENED 06:00 GMT+8			
ES (E-mini S&P)	7,828.25	▼ 3.50 -0.04%	15,191 lots — 1.0% of the 10-day average . Range 7,827.75-7,834.00. This is not a move; it is an empty book. Basis to cash +63.6pts (+0.82%).
NQ (E-mini Nasdaq-100)	31,017.25	▼ 11.25 -0.04%	17,489 lots, 3.7% of average — the only contract with any participation. High of 31,070.50 matches its 52-week high.
YM (E-mini Dow)	52,250	▼ 29 -0.06%	1,261 lots, 1.8% of average. Basis +386pts (+0.74%) — consistent with ES, so both cash rows are genuine settles.
RTY (E-mini Russell)	2,910.40	▼ 3.70 -0.13%	1,401 lots, 0.7% of average. Basis +0.71%. Closed the overnight session on its own low.
US TREASURY YIELDS — LIVE CASH SERIES			
US 10-year	4.955%	▲ 0.4bp	Session range 4.920-4.984%. Yields did not move on Tuesday — which matters, because it means the financials rout had no same-day rate catalyst.
US 30-year	5.295%	▲ 1.5bp	High of 5.367%. The pressure point of the curve: 34.0bp of term premium over the 10-year is all that is left.
US 5-year	4.827%	◆ 0.0bp	Unmoved to three decimals, having ranged 4.791-4.944%. A 15bp round trip that ended precisely where it started.
US 2-year	4.747%	▼ 0.4bp	Sits 0.041pp below its own 52-week high. 10s2s = 20.8bp , 5s2s just 8.0bp.
US 13-week bill	4.105%	▲ 2.1bp	At its 52-week high. 10s3m still +85.0bp, so the front of the curve is the part being crushed.
ENERGY — LIVE FUTURES			
WTI (CL front)	\$90.09	▼ 0.43 -0.48%	Eight cents below the floor of Hedgeye's 90.17-108.16 band, on the day Keith said he had started buying oil. Closed the overnight at 89% of a 70-cent range.
Brent (BZ front)	\$99.07	▼ 0.18 -0.18%	Clinging to the 99 handle. Keith's stated trade/trend marks are ~97/90 and he said neither had broken.
Natural gas (NG front)	\$3.025	▲ 0.060 +2.02%	6.5 cents above the ceiling of a 2.74-2.96 bearish band. Lower-48 production at its weakest since early August; first heating-demand forecasts of the season.
RBOB gasoline	\$3.2121	▼ 0.010 -0.31%	Crack to WTI still the tightest constraint in the complex; 14.7% below the 52-week high of 3.764.
METALS — LIVE SPOT (THE SERIES HEDGEYE'S BANDS NAME)			
Gold spot	\$4,350.15	▼ 6.43 -0.15%	

Closed the overnight on its exact low — 0.0% of a \$19 range. 68.5% of a 4244-4399 neutral band. **22.3% below** the January 2026 peak near \$5,599. This is a drawdown, not a melt-up.

Silver spot	\$66.95	▼ 0.04 -0.06%	95 cents above the ceiling of a 62-66 band Hedgeye marks bearish. Still 44.96% below its early-2026 spike.
Copper spot	\$6.7662	▼ 0.019 -0.28%	0.74% from its 52-week high and at 92.5% of its band. The quietest row on this page doing the loudest thing.
FX & CRYPTO — LIVE			
DX	100.589	▲ 0.048 +0.05%	69.4% of a 99.68-100.99 bullish band. Range this morning just 4.8 ticks — a few hours of thin trade, not a signal.
USD/JPY	157.575	▲ 0.195 +0.12%	Back in the zone that triggered the first joint US-Japan yen-buying operation since 1998, in late July. The BoJ hiked on 18 September and the yen fell anyway.
USD/KRW	1,350.93	▼ 4.54 -0.33%	Won firmer. 13.5% above its 52-week low of 1,334.11; ING has argued a sustained break below 1,350 is hard with the Fed hiking.
Bitcoin	\$86,595	▲ 419 +0.49%	The only genuinely 24-hour row here. 31.4% below its 52-week high of 126,230 even after the squeeze. Ether +0.48% at \$2,766.

▲ up ▼ down ◆ unchanged. Cash equity and VIX rows are **settled closes** from Tuesday 22 September, 5h 11m old at capture. Every other row is a **live print captured in a 2.4-second window at 09:10:50-09:10:53 GMT+8**; the futures feed carries a ~10-minute delay, so those four rows are effectively 09:00. Futures, FX and spot-metal changes are measured against the prior settle. Reconciliation: all six cash indices are internally self-consistent (close – change = prior close, and the implied percentage matches the stated one, to five decimal places); the ES/YM/RTY bases to cash cluster at +0.82%/+0.74%/+0.71%, an 11bp spread, which is what confirms the cash rows are settles and the futures rows are live. Yahoo Finance returned nothing this morning, so every row is single-sourced from TradingView — see section 18.

TL;DR

The Nasdaq Composite made a record intraday high and a record close. On the same tape the Dow opened seventeen points off its high and finished **438 points lower**, and financials fell **1.97% on 69.8 million XLF shares** — nearly four times the volume of any other sector ETF bar energy. Yields did not move to explain it. This is the tenth session since the Federal Reserve's **first rate rise since 2023**, and the rate-sensitive half of the market is still repricing while the AI half melts up. Four of Hedgeye's sixteen risk ranges are broken this morning — **VIX and WTI below their floors, natural gas and silver above their ceilings** — and the 10s2s curve sits at **20.8bp**, which Keith McCullough calls the biggest macro problem since early 2022.

2 The big picture — what it means

The index that told the truth on Tuesday was the Dow, not the Nasdaq. A record close is a fact about seven companies; the Dow opening at 52,301.92 — within 17 points of its high — and closing at 51,863.69 is a fact about the other four hundred and ninety-three. It gave back 438 points from the open and finished at 23% of a 593-point range. The S&P 500 landing dead flat at 7,764.64 is not calm; it is two opposing forces of roughly equal size cancelling each other inside one print.

Financials were the day's real event and nothing in the rate market explains them. XLF fell 1.97% on 69,837,419 shares, against 7-10 million for most other sector ETFs. The 10-year moved 0.4bp; the 2-year moved 0.4bp the other way. So this was not a yield shock — it was position unwind. Charles Schwab fell 6.11%, Raymond James roughly 3.6-5.0% depending on which tape you read, and Allstate fell 5.26% after disclosing **\$748m of estimated catastrophe losses for August alone**. Schwab's own guidance is that 25bp of fed funds moves annualised net interest revenue by \$250-300m; the market is marking that in the wrong direction for the first time in three years.

The hinge is that the Federal Reserve is now hiking. On 16 September the FOMC raised the target range 25bp to **3.75-4.00%** — the first increase since 2023 — under Chair Kevin Warsh, with hawkish commentary and a median participant seeing two hikes this year. Richmond Fed President Thomas Barkin, speaking to the CFA Society of Baltimore at 01:00 GMT+8, put it plainly: *"The risks to inflation outweigh the risks to maximum employment. That's why we raised rates."* Asked about more, he said *"We'll see."* Two third-party proxies put the odds of another 25bp on 28 October in the high fifties to about sixty per cent; they disagree by roughly four points and we could not reach CME's own figure.

A 20.8bp 10s2s curve with a hiking central bank is the most uncomfortable number in this document. Hedgeye's September CPI nowcast has risen to **3.67% year-on-year against 3.40% last reported**, which is why the long end will not rally and the front end cannot. The 5s2s spread is 8.0bp. The 30-year at 5.295% carries just 34bp over the 10-year. McCullough compared the compression directly to the early stages of the 2022 inversion and said, in terms, that this is not a setup to buy financials — a call Tuesday's tape validated within hours.

Oil fell on diplomacy, and the diplomacy is reversible. Iran told Reuters on Tuesday it could reopen the Strait of Hormuz within seven days if the United States eases military pressure and lifts its port blockade; Trump told the UN General Assembly he expects a deal after the midterms, and US and Iranian delegations held roughly three

hours of indirect talks on the sidelines. WTI at \$90.09 is a war price that has come down, not a cycle price that has gone up — Brent traded to about \$126 in April. Every cent of the decline is a headline that can be un-said, which is precisely why McCullough was buying into it rather than selling.

The memory complex, not the Magnificent Seven, carried the tape. Micron rose 5.00%, SanDisk 6.82% after Rosenblatt initiated coverage at Buy with a \$2,400 target, Western Digital 3.67% and Seagate 4.85%. Of the Magnificent Seven, four fell — Alphabet 1.07%, Amazon 1.34%, Microsoft 0.72% and Meta 0.63% — and the combined \$24.57 trillion was not what moved the index. Rosenblatt's argument is worth the attention: that new AI compute platforms reposition NAND from a commodity storage medium into system-critical infrastructure, and that SanDisk has struck business-model agreements with eight of its largest customers covering roughly 65% of fiscal-2028 production. Contracted volume is what breaks a boom-bust cycle, if it holds.

Beneath a record index sit enormous individual drawdowns. Oracle closed at \$149.20, **53.7% below** its 52-week high of \$322.54. Netflix at \$72.16 is 42.2% below its. Utilities at 40.53 are 0.20% off their 52-week low and down more than 10% this quarter. Bitcoin is 31.4% below its 52-week high after what was described as a squeeze. A record close on the Nasdaq Composite and a market in which this much is 40–55% off its highs are the same market. That is what a narrow tape looks like from the inside.

3 Rates, currencies & commodities

- **The curve is the trade.** 10s2s at 20.8bp, 5s2s at 8.0bp, 30s10s at 34.0bp, 10s3m still +85.0bp. The compression is happening between two and ten years — the segment that prices the Fed's terminal rate — which says the market believes the hiking cycle is short, and is pricing the damage of it being wrong.
- **Bond volatility fell on the day but Hedgeye is buying it.** The MOVE index dropped 3.25% to 78.56, near the lower half of a 55.77–115.02 annual range. McCullough disclosed a new allocation to PFIX to express *rising* bond volatility — a position taken against the immediate tape, alongside a new long in Energy.
- **The dollar is doing very little, loudly.** DXY at 100.589 is 69.4% of its band and flipped bullish on 17 September, the day after the hike. Its entire range in the hours we captured was 4.8 ticks; do not read a trend into a 0.05% change measured over an empty session.
- **The yuan is the cleanest signal in FX.** USD/CNH at 6.6965 is **0.08% from its 52-week low** — the strongest the currency has been in a year. Reuters reported the PBoC fixed at 6.7487, strongest since February 2023 and the eighth consecutive stronger fix, having spent most of a year deliberately setting guidance weaker than expected to slow appreciation. OCBC's caution is the right one: this is policy-managed stability around the Trump-Xi summit, not a re-rating.
- **Copper is 0.74% from a 52-week high on a policy deadline nobody has answered.** Commerce has proposed duties on refined copper of 15% from January 2027 and 30% from 2028, pending a presidential decision that did not arrive on its 8 September deadline. LME copper set an all-time intraday high of \$14,875/tonne on 10 September and then fell 4.7% on COMEX within hours on reports the escalation was losing momentum. Underneath the policy noise, global mine production fell 1.1% year-on-year in the first half.
- **Silver's price is falling and its physical market is not.** Spot at \$66.95 is 45% below the early-2026 spike, yet specialist trade press reports implied lease rates of 7–8% against a pre-2025 norm below 1%, a futures curve in backwardation, and a sixth consecutive annual supply deficit. None of that is wire-confirmed, and it is worth exactly the confidence that implies — but a backwardated curve and a falling price do not normally coexist.
- **Gold is consolidating inside a bull trend, not topping.** \$4,350 is 22.3% below the January peak, but central banks bought a reported record 289 tonnes in the second quarter — buying *into* a 14% quarterly decline. Hedgeye has gone the other way: silver sold, gold miners exited, gold reduced below minimum size, with AAAU the remaining exposure. McCullough marks gold bearish trade and says it turns bearish trend below roughly 4,250.

4 Hedgeye — regime, risk ranges & the Quad path

Macro dashboard

SIGNAL	READING	HEDGEYE'S READ
Quad path	NOT PRINTED	No explicit path notation appeared in the Early Look or the Macro Show notes we read. The regime is repeatedly described as #Quad2 , but the path is unknown and we assert nothing . Absence of a printed path is not evidence it is unchanged.
10s2s yield curve	20.8bp (Hedgeye cited ~19bp)	"Probably the biggest problem" since early 2022. New #Quad2 cycle lows. Explicitly <i>not</i> a setup to buy financials.
September CPI nowcast	3.67% y/y vs 3.40% last reported	Accelerating rate of change supports higher-for-longer yields and a hawkish Fed.
Gamma regime	Flipped negative → positive	

		SPX reclaimed immediate-term TRADE. Stopped adding shorts, covered some quickly. Warns short-dated vol compressing toward 10-12 is a dangerous setup if it reverses.
New allocations	Energy (XLE), bond vol (PFI)	Both bought Tuesday. Energy "on sale"; PFI expresses rising bond volatility into a falling MOVE.
Bullish TREND equities	META, MSFT, AAPL, GOOGL, NVDA, SPCX, TXG	Long the leaders, not the Nasdaq index. Long Software (IGV) instead.
Short book	XLU, Industrials, Russell 2000 (min size), India, Switzerland, Germany	Switzerland and Germany are new shorts; the semiconductor short was covered . XLU down >10% quarter-to-date.
Crypto	Long BTC (IBIT) and ETH (ETHA)	Bitcoin-sensitive equities were the #1 factor at +5.1%. Explicit warning against chasing on up days.

Risk Range™ Signals — Early Look, 22 September 07:26 ET (19:26 GMT+8)

INSTRUMENT	RANGE	TREND	WHERE IT STANDS NOW
UST 10-year yield	4.85-5.10	bullish	4.955 — 42.0% of band, mid-range. 14.5bp of room down, 14.5bp up.
High Yield (HYG)	78.28-78.98	bearish	78.67 — 55.7%. A 70-cent band; credit is signalling nothing either way.
Inv. Grade (LQD)	103.6-105.6	bearish	105.09 — 74.5%, pressing the upper half of a bearish band.
S&P 500 (SPX)	7532-7797	bullish	7,764.64 — 87.8% . 32 points from the ceiling.
NASDAQ Composite	25901-27305	bullish	27,244.28 — 95.7% , 61 points from the ceiling. The most extended row here.
Russell 2000 (RUT)	2834-2825	bearish	Printed inverted — floor above ceiling. We reproduce it as published and draw no conclusion. RUT settled 2,889.92, above both numbers.
Health Care (XLV)	164-171	bullish	169.89 — 84.1%.
Software (IGV)	102-110	bullish	Not captured this run; IGV is outside our instrument list. Position unknown.
Energy (XLE)	61.57-65.98	bullish	61.78 — 4.8% , twenty-one cents off the floor. This is the level Hedgeye bought.
Volatility (VIX)	14.24-17.85	bearish	14.22 — BELOW the floor by 0.02 . Broken to the downside.
US Dollar (USD)	99.68-100.99	bullish	100.589 — 69.4%.
Crude, WTIC continuous	90.17-108.16	bullish	90.09 — BELOW the floor by 0.08 . Broken, by eight cents, on the day it was bought.
Nat gas continuous	2.74-2.96	bearish	3.025 — ABOVE the ceiling by 0.065 . Broken to the upside.
Gold spot	4244-4399	neutral	4,350.15 — 68.5%. Measured on TVC:GOLD; the COMEX future at 4,395.40 would have read 97.7% and been wrong by 29 points of band.
Copper spot	6.35-6.80	bullish	6.7662 — 92.5% , 3.4 cents from the ceiling. The future at 6.8835 is already through it.
Silver spot	62-66	bearish	66.95 — ABOVE the ceiling by 0.95 . Broken to the upside against a bearish signal.

Band moves versus the prior session: UNKNOWN. Hedgeye's category-filtered feed does not paginate — ?page=2, ?page=3 and &per_page=5 all return the identical single note, and /research/early-look resolves to an error page. We could not reach Monday's Early Look by any route tried, so we cannot state whether any floor, ceiling or band width moved. This is not a claim that they were unchanged. — Metals measured on spot and energy on the continuous contract, per the series Hedgeye names; using futures instead would have misread gold by 29 points of band and copper by 26 percentage points of position.

What Keith actually said

From the Early Look, "Jail's #Quad2 Squeeze!", published 22 September 07:26 ET / **19:26 GMT+8**:

- On the curve: "Yield Curve just got smashed to new #Quad2 Cycle Lows at +19bps wide on 10s minus 2s", and "Both USD and UST 2yr Yield Signals are signaling higher-lows and higher-highs for #Quad2".
- On the squeeze: "If the #MOAB (Mother of All Bubbles) wasn't a thing, you wouldn't have had that kind of #Quad2 Short Squeeze yesterday. The bubble going back up is the point. That's why it's called a bubble and not a ceiling."
- On energy: "Did you know that the Fractal Gods just told me to buy some Brent Oil (BNO) on sale this morning? They're telling me to buy some Large Cap Energy (XLE) exposure too."
- On the small-cap divergence: "Russell 2000 (IWM) barely bounced yesterday and is still in -6.3% drawdown", and "Our #1 Sector Style Short, Utilities (XLU) was down another -1.1% yesterday to -10.3% for Q3 alone!"
- The top three factor squeezes he listed for Monday: Bitcoin-sensitive equities **+5.1%**, high-retail-sentiment **+4.9%**, most-shortest **+2.3%**.

The Macro Show material above is drawn from Hedgeye's own Summary Notes for Tuesday 22 September, 10:34 ET / 22:34 GMT+8. Those notes carry the publisher's own disclaimer — "SUMMARY HAS BEEN ENHANCED BY AI AND MAY CONTAIN ERRORS" — so they are reported here as attributed summary and deliberately **not** placed inside quotation marks. Only the Early Look text above is quoted verbatim.

5 Mag7 scoreboard

NAME	LAST	DAY	CAP	READ
NVIDIA	228.87	+0.66%	\$5.52T	Bullish TREND per Hedgeye. 3.2% below its 52-week high. Carried the SOX without leading it.
Apple	339.75	+0.23%	\$4.96T	Intraday high of 345.34 is its 52-week high; gave back nearly all of it. Bullish TREND.
Alphabet	351.16	-1.07%	\$4.27T	Worst of the seven. Ranged 350.22-364.17 and closed on the low. 14.1% below its 52-week high.
Microsoft	498.00	-0.72%	\$3.70T	Lost the 500 handle, low of 493.65. +0.70% after hours to 501.48 — the largest post-close move of the seven.
Amazon	254.98	-1.34%	\$2.75T	Blocked Meta's Muse agent from Amazon.com the same week Shopify integrated it with Shop Pay. The agentic-commerce fight has started.
Meta Platforms	736.60	-0.63%	\$1.88T	Ranged 730.00-757.27 — a 3.7% swing — after Monday's reported +11.4%, its best day in 17 months. Meta Connect runs today and tomorrow.
Tesla	378.90	+0.96%	\$1.50T	Best of the seven, and still 24.0% below its 52-week high — the deepest drawdown in the group.

Combined capitalisation **\$24.57 trillion**. Four of seven fell on a day the Nasdaq Composite closed at a record: the index did not need them. Capitalisations are TradingView's market_cap_basic at capture and move with the live price.

6 Positioning & options

- **Gamma flipped positive as SPX reclaimed immediate-term TRADE.** Hedgeye stopped adding shorts and covered some quickly on the flip — positive dealer gamma lets an upside move feed on itself. The stated risk is the reverse: short-dated volatility compressing toward 10-12 and then turning.
- **VIX closed at 14.22, on the low of its day and below its risk-range floor**, with a 52-week low of 13.38 only 5.9% further down. There is very little room left in this direction.
- **Sector volume told the story the price did not.** XLF traded 69.8m shares and XLE 39.3m; every other sector ETF traded between 4.8m and 18.9m. Concentrated volume in the two losing sectors is distribution, not drift.
- **Index volume was unremarkable.** S&P 500 turnover ran 98.4% of its 10-day average and the Dow 98.2%; the Nasdaq Composite ran 104.0% and QQQ 113.0%. The record was made on ordinary participation in everything except the Nasdaq complex.
- **SPY traded only 73.9% of its 10-day average** while IWM ran 103.0%. Retail-facing small-cap exposure was more active than the core S&P vehicle on a flat day — consistent with the high-retail-sentiment and most-shortest baskets being the ones that squeezed.
- **Overnight futures participation is effectively nil** — ES at 1.0% of average, RTY at 0.7%. Any level quoted from those books this morning is a price, not a market.
- **Hedgeye's short book is now global rather than domestic.** Switzerland and Germany were added as new shorts specifically because McCullough declined to add US shorts into the rally. That is a deliberate transfer of hedging risk offshore.

7 Sector rotation — leaders & laggards

SECTOR (SPDR)	LAST	DAY	VOLUME	NOTE
Materials (XLB)	50.53	+1.65%	10.4m	Day's leader, on copper and a broad cyclical bid.
Staples (XLP)	82.73	+0.99%	10.3m	Defensives second. A leaderboard of materials and staples is not a risk-on leaderboard.
Technology (XLK)	196.27	+0.73%	8.7m	1.2% below its 52-week high. Lagged the SOX by 133bp — the strength was memory, not tech broadly.
Health Care (XLV)	169.89	+0.52%	7.1m	Ranged 167.86-170.72. At 84.1% of its Hedgeye band.
Industrials (XLI)	170.27	+0.17%	7.2m	Barely positive. One of Hedgeye's two sector-style shorts.
Cons. Discretionary (XLY)	112.33	+0.09%	7.6m	Opened 112.98 and closed 112.33 — faded all day. 10.1% below its 52-week high.
Real Estate (XLRE)	42.50	-0.21%	4.8m	Lightest volume on the board. A 5.295% 30-year is the whole story.

Utilities (XLU)	40.53	-0.32%	18.9m	0.20% above its 52-week low on the third-heaviest sector volume. Down >10% this quarter. Hedgeye's #1 sector short.
Comm. Services (XLC)	113.53	-1.06%	7.4m	Dragged by Alphabet and Meta together.
Energy (XLE)	61.78	-1.09%	39.3m	Second-heaviest volume, at 4.8% of its band. Bought by Hedgeye at exactly this level.
Financials (XLF)	54.80	-1.97%	69.8m	Opened 56.00, closed 54.80 — at 16.7% of a 2.75% range, on more volume than the next two sectors combined.

- **Leaders:** Materials, Staples, Technology. Two of those three are what you buy when you are reducing cyclical risk, not adding it.
- **Laggards:** Financials, Energy, Communication Services — and the two worst also had the two heaviest volumes. Where the selling and the volume coincide is where conviction is.
- **The rotation is rate-sensitivity, not growth-versus-value.** Technology rose and Financials fell on a day yields did not move; Real Estate and Utilities both fell. What links the losers is duration exposure to a central bank that has changed direction, not a style factor.
- **Eight of eleven sectors moved less than 1.1%.** XLF's 1.97% is nearly double the next-largest decline. This was not a broad risk-off day; it was one sector being sold.
- **After-hours drift is directionless** — the largest post-close sector move was XLRE at +0.21% and six sectors moved less than 0.1%. Nothing that happened after 16:00 ET changed the sector picture.

8 Forward — futures & the week ahead

The overnight tape has done nothing and has done it on almost no volume. ES sits at 7,828.25, three and a half points below Tuesday's settle, on **15,191 contracts — one per cent of its ten-day average**; RTY has traded 1,401 lots. All four contracts are marginally lower and all four are within a few ticks of where Globex reopened at 06:00 GMT+8. NQ's overnight high of 31,070.50 matches its 52-week high, which is the single most interesting thing in an otherwise empty book. In FX, DXY has covered 4.8 ticks and EUR/USD 5.2 pips since the reopen. **Treat every change figure in this section as noise.** The one genuinely live, genuinely liquid market is crypto, where Bitcoin is +0.49% and Ether +0.48%. The real event risk sits in the calendar below, not in the tape.

DAY (GMT+8)	KEY EVENTS
Wed 23 Sep today	21:45 S&P Global flash US manufacturing & services PMIs, September — <i>consensus not found</i> . 22:05 Fed Governor Michael Barr. 22:30 EIA weekly petroleum status report — <i>API print and Street consensus both unavailable; see section 18</i> . Xi Jinping arrives in Washington for a state visit. Meta Connect 2026, day one. Earnings pre-open: Cintas (\$1.35e), General Mills (\$0.72e), Paychex (\$1.32e), Cracker Barrel (\$0.16e); post-close: H.B. Fuller (\$1.47e), Stitch Fix (-\$0.06e).
Thu 24 Sep	20:30 Initial jobless claims. 22:00 New home sales, August. Fed speakers Williams (16:10), Hammack (20:50), Paulson (22:10). Trump-Xi summit and White House state dinner — agenda covers the trade truce, tariffs, AI, critical minerals, Taiwan and Iran; tech chief executives expected. Costco after the close: consensus \$6.53 on revenue \$94.9bn. Darden pre-open (\$2.05e).
Fri 25 Sep	20:30 Durable goods orders, August. 22:00 University of Michigan consumer sentiment, September final — the preliminary was 47.8, the second-lowest reading on record , against a 51.0 consensus, with year-ahead inflation expectations at 4.6%. Hammack again at 02:00 Saturday.
Mon 28 - Wed 30 Sep	29 Sep: Conference Board consumer confidence; RBA decision — all four Australian majors look for +25bp to 4.60%. 30 Sep: Micron FQ4 results , the single most important print for the complex that led Tuesday's tape.
Ahead	27-28 October FOMC — a non-SEP meeting, no dot plot. Date confirmed against the Federal Reserve's own calendar. 10 November: China's suspension of rare-earth export controls expires — Beijing's leverage in this week's summit.

US times converted to GMT+8 at +12h (US daylight time). Earnings estimates are from secondary calendars sourced to Refinitiv/LSEG and Briefing.com and are **unconfirmed** against exchange calendars, except Micron's 30 September date and the 27-28 October FOMC, both verified against the companies' and the Fed's own publications. Consensus figures for the flash PMIs, jobless claims, new home sales and durable goods could not be found and are deliberately left blank rather than guessed.

9 Corporate news

- **Rosenblatt initiated SanDisk at Buy with a \$2,400 target** and the stock rose 6.82% to \$1,887.04. Analyst Kevin Cassidy's argument is structural: NAND moving from commodity storage to system-critical AI infrastructure, and business-model agreements with eight of SanDisk's largest customers covering an estimated **65% of fiscal-2028 production**. He named reversion to commodity pricing as the counterweight.
- **Cisco fell 4.50% to \$106.44 after Piper Sandler's James Fish cut his target to \$125 from \$132, keeping a Neutral rating.** No earnings, no guidance cut, no filing. The stock ranged 104.51-110.43 and underperformed

its own sector by roughly six percentage points; it is now below its 20-, 50- and 100-day averages. Reported magnitudes range from -3.3% to -5.6% across outlets; we use the -4.50% our own capture returned.

- **Berkshire Hathaway bought more than \$200m of Lennar over three trading days and now holds just over 10%** of the second-largest US homebuilder. Lennar rose between 5.3% and 6.4% depending on the tape.
- **Paramount Skydance rose 6.51%** after settling with twelve state attorneys general and the Writers Guild of America, clearing a major legal obstacle to its \$81bn acquisition of Warner Bros. Discovery.
- **Viking Therapeutics rose 31.55%** — the day's largest move — on topline maintenance-dosing data for VK2735: roughly 16-19% weight loss at 21 weeks against approximately zero on placebo, and, in the maintenance phase, up to 97% of prior weight loss preserved on every-other-week dosing and up to 90% on monthly. A Phase III start is guided for year-end.
- **Quest Diagnostics fell 6.08%** after CMS published preliminary proposals that could cut clinical laboratory fee schedule payments by up to 15% from 1 January 2027. Genuine regulatory news with read-through to the whole lab sector.
- **After the close:** KB Home reported FQ3 EPS of **\$1.05 against \$0.89 consensus** on revenue of \$1.30bn, but guided Q4 housing gross margin down to 16.0-16.6% and left full-year revenue at \$4.9-5.1bn, a midpoint about 2% below models; the stock fell 2.23% after hours having risen 1.53% in the session. Worthington Enterprises reported adjusted EPS of **\$0.82 against \$0.75** on sales up 13% to \$343.9m. Before the open, AutoZone beat on EPS at **\$56.05 against roughly \$54.54** but **missed on revenue at \$6.59bn against \$6.69bn**.
- **Other notable moves:** Expedia -22.59% (Morgan Stanley to Underweight), Medpace -21.82% on executive stock sales, Celldex -12.19%, Planet Fitness -9.08%, New York Times -8.65%, Coterra Energy -8.62% on the oil move, Monolithic Power +8.06% as the top S&P winner. Drivers for Celldex, Planet Fitness, the New York Times and Monolithic Power could not be established.

10 Macro data

- **Richmond Fed manufacturing index, September: -2 actual against +5 consensus, from +4 prior.** A seven-point miss and the first negative print in months, roughly 1.2 standard deviations below forecast. The internals are worse than the headline: shipments fell to -5 from +11 and new orders to -6 from +3. Employment was the sole bright spot, improving to +7 from -2.
- **Philadelphia Fed non-manufacturing survey, September: the firm-level general activity index rose to +0.3 from -8.2, while the regional index fell to -22.0 from -10.6.** Consensus for neither was found. The two sub-indices point opposite ways and outlets quoted them interchangeably; treat the headline as ambiguous. The genuinely notable detail is that **full-time employment jumped 17 points to its best level in over four years, with 27% of firms adding staff against 14% in August** — and that prices paid and received are ratcheting higher again.
- **Richmond Fed's Thomas Barkin, 01:00 GMT+8, was the hawkish event of the day.** On the hike: "*The risks to inflation outweigh the risks to maximum employment. That's why we raised rates.*" On more: "*We'll see.*" On persistence: "*'Passing' shocks aren't proving to be short-lived, or one-off events*" — a warning that pressures risk becoming entrenched and are not limited to energy and tariffs. He described US conditions as, if anything, firming.
- **New York Fed's John Williams (22:05) and Vice Chair Philip Jefferson (22:20) both spoke at the NY Fed's Treasury Market Conference on plumbing, not policy.** Williams defended the ample-reserves framework as "highly effective at delivering interest rate control", noted it "is not set in stone", and said the shift from uncleared to cleared Treasury markets is running **ahead of schedule**. Jefferson's subject was discount-window modernisation. Neither moved the rate path.
- **It was a deliberately light data day inside a heavy Fed-speaker week** — roughly ten central-bank appearances scheduled. That is why Barkin carried the whole signal.
- **The number that matters most is not Tuesday's.** The University of Michigan preliminary September sentiment reading of **47.8** — down 7.5% on August, the second-lowest on record, against a 51.0 consensus — with year-ahead inflation expectations at **4.6%**, the highest since June. The final lands Friday. A hiking Fed, a 4.6% inflation expectation and a near-record-low sentiment print are a difficult combination to hold simultaneously.

11 Geopolitics

- **▲ Iran told Reuters it could reopen the Strait of Hormuz within seven days** if the United States eases military pressure and lifts its port blockade. Trump told the UN General Assembly he expects a deal after the US midterms and, according to envoy Steve Witkoff, US and Iranian delegations held roughly three hours of **indirect** talks on the sidelines with mediators shuttling. Trump characterised it as having "went very well". These are the parties' own characterisations. Shipping through the strait collapsed to between eight and fifteen vessels a day in early August, against roughly 130 before the war.
- **◆ Xi Jinping arrives in Washington today**, his first US visit in three years, with the summit and state dinner on Thursday. Two announcements are widely expected — an extension of the trade truce and tariff relief — and

Reuters sources say Xi will press Trump to halt Taiwan arms sales under the 1982 joint communiqué, with a \$14bn US package awaiting final approval. Analysts broadly expect no breakthrough. China's suspension of rare-earth export controls expires on 10 November; that is the leverage.

- **▼ All EU sanctions on Russia were due to expire at midnight on 22 September absent a unanimous renewal, and we could not confirm whether that renewal cleared.** Latvia's prime minister said publicly that Latvia would reject a deal delisting Alisher Usmanov and Mikhail Fridman in exchange for keeping thousands of other designations. **This is a live, unresolved and genuinely market-relevant item — verify it before acting on anything Russia-adjacent.**
- **◆ Macron said he discussed with Trump proposals for a Russia-Ukraine moratorium on attacks against energy infrastructure,** describing the conversations as "very good" and "very constructive". If it advances it is directly bearish crude and European gas. Overnight Russian strikes on Dnipro, Kryvyi Rih and Pavlohrad killed four and cut power to thousands.
- **▼ Yemen is the escalation vector nobody is watching.** Houthi forces pushed to seize highlands separating the Red Sea coast from Saudi-coalition areas. The UK said it will provide air-to-air refuelling for Saudi aircraft, framed as a matter of weeks, and G7 foreign ministers called on Iran to stop arming the Houthis. Putin and the Saudi crown prince jointly called for safe passage through both Hormuz and Bab el-Mandeb on Tuesday.
- **◆ Trump used a 37-minute UN General Assembly address to say he is deciding whether to strike a deal with Iran or "annihilate" the country, to reject international regulation of AI, and to call on all International Criminal Court member states to resign.** Reported as his own words; the AI line collides directly with OpenAI's proposal, published the previous day, urging the United States to lead an international standards effort.
- **◆ The United States plans to open two military bases in Greenland** under a US-Greenland-Denmark agreement, reopening the Cold War-era Narsarsuaq site and adding an east-coast base. Sourced to unnamed officials via Reuters; treat accordingly.

12 Overnight setup — what Asia opens into

This edition fired at 09:10 GMT+8, three hours and ten minutes after schedule. Tokyo, Seoul and Sydney have therefore been trading for between ten and seventy minutes at capture, and Hong Kong opens in twenty. This is not the usual pre-Asia-open snapshot, and the section is written accordingly.

INSTRUMENT	LIVE 09:10:50	CHANGE	VOLUME
ES / NQ / YM / RTY	7,828.25 / 31,017.25 / 52,250 / 2,910.40	-0.04 / -0.04 / -0.06 / -0.13%	15,191 / 17,489 / 1,261 / 1,401
USD/JPY	157.575	+0.12%	30,974
USD/KRW	1,350.93	-0.33%	1,399
USD/TWD	31.6645	+0.04%	295
USD/CNH	6.6965	-0.03%	7,025
EUR/USD	1.14449	-0.03%	8,602
Gold / silver / copper spot	4,350.15 / 66.95 / 6.7662	-0.15 / -0.06 / -0.28%	—
WTI / Brent	90.09 / 99.07	-0.48 / -0.18%	6,865 / 769
Bitcoin / Ether	86,595 / 2,766.34	+0.49 / +0.48%	—

- **The US tape hands Asia a semiconductor bid and a financials problem.** SOX +2.06%, memory names up 3.7-6.8%, XLF -1.97%. For Seoul and Taipei that is unambiguously the good half; for Tokyo's banks and Hong Kong's financials it is the bad half.
- **Korea is the instrument most likely to move.** Samsung's entire 2026 HBM capacity is reported pre-sold and SK Hynix's HBM revenue share fell from roughly 58% to 50% between the first and second quarters as Samsung's HBM4 ramped. A US memory session like Tuesday's transmits to Seoul directly, and USD/KRW at 1,350.93 — firmer by 0.33% — is already leaning that way.
- **The single most watched print of the Asian day is the PBoC fix at 09:15 Beijing.** Reuters reported Monday's midpoint at 6.7487, the strongest since February 2023 and the eighth consecutive stronger fix, with the gap to market estimates narrowing sharply after a year of deliberately weaker guidance. With Xi landing in Washington today, the fix is a policy statement.
- **Previous Asian closes, all marked as such.** Tuesday 22 September: Nikkei 225 **65,018.73**, Hang Seng **25,087.76**, KOSPI **7,092.08**, Shanghai Composite **3,952.13**, Sensex **74,529.08**. ASX 200 at **8,766.5** appears to be a live Wednesday print. The day-change fields on several of these disagree with wire snapshots — see section 18 — so the levels are reported and the percentage changes are not.
- **Japan is the intervention risk.** USD/JPY at 157.58 is back in the region that prompted the first joint US-Japan yen-buying operation since 1998 in late July, and the BoJ's 18 September hike weakened rather than strengthened the currency. A hike that fails to support a currency is the setup that brings the finance ministry back.

- **Australia has the only scheduled data.** Flash September PMIs land at 07:00 GMT+8 Thursday; August finals were services 53.2, manufacturing 52.0, composite 52.7, with input costs rising on fuel and freight. The price components matter more than the headline into an RBA meeting all four major banks expect to deliver +25bp to 4.60% on 29 September.

13 AI watch

- **Alibaba unveiled the Zhenwu V900 AI chip at its Apsara conference in Hangzhou on Tuesday** — reported at roughly three times the prior generation, 216GB of HBM, 1.2 TB/s inter-chip bandwidth, scalable to 500,000-chip clusters, with mass production early in 2027. Chief executive Eddie Wu said Alibaba Cloud will expand data-centre capacity beyond 20 gigawatts by 2032, and outlined a next-generation Qwen model of five to ten trillion parameters. Announced two days before a summit whose agenda includes AI.
- **AI credit is where the strain is showing first.** Reuters reports spreads on AI-related investment-grade corporate debt have widened relative to the broader IG market, with hyperscaler issuance projected at up to **\$420bn in 2027**. Bond investors beginning to differentiate by expected return on data-centre capex is a more meaningful signal than any equity move in this section.
- **A New York Times investigation alleges the California server maker Aivres exported at least \$5.6bn of advanced technology to Southeast Asia between April 2024 and February 2026**, including more than \$3bn of servers carrying NVIDIA Blackwell chips that ultimately served Chinese customers including ByteDance and Alibaba. Single-investigation sourcing; the company's response was not captured. This is the kind of story that moves export-control policy, and it lands in summit week.
- **Governor Newsom signed a seven-bill data-centre package on Monday:** mandatory electricity and water disclosure, developers funding grid and water upgrades, tighter local review, loss of CEQA shortcuts, and a CPUC-created separate rate class so transmission and wildfire costs are not shifted to households. It raises the all-in cost of Californian AI campuses.
- **Amazon blocked Meta's Muse shopping agent from Amazon.com while Shopify integrated it with Shop Pay.** Muse — which topped the US iOS free chart with more than 730,000 downloads and drove Monday's melt-up — is also the subject of a disclosed zero-day in its Mac app allowing local privilege escalation; Meta has shipped a hotfix and characterises the flaw as local rather than remote.
- **OpenAI says an internal model has resolved more than a hundred long-standing open mathematics problems, including a claimed solution to the Navier-Stokes Millennium Prize problem.** The claimed solutions have **not** been released for independent verification. This is OpenAI's claim and is reported here as such, not as fact. Separately, British Columbia has sued the company over a failure to report a chatbot user's violent statements, one of more than thirty suits filed by victims' families.
- **The most useful contrarian voice of the day came from a central banker.** RBA Governor Michele Bullock said there is not yet clear evidence AI is improving national productivity, that it could form part of a speculative bubble, that firms often see *lower* productivity while adapting to new technology, and that rising data-centre investment costs are themselves adding to inflationary pressure.

14 Beyond the markets

- **The White House television press pool has stopped functioning.** The pool chair told members that the TV pool "will not be covering events designated as pool coverage of the President"; Trump was subsequently inaudible during a press conference. Print and photo pools continue. Separately, CNN, MS NOW and Politico are suing the White House over a reporter ban.
- **US Immigration and Customs Enforcement quietly removed detainees subject to final deportation orders from its online detainee locator on 15 September**, without announcement. Lawyers report clients vanishing from the system; the American Immigration Lawyers Association warned members late last week. Several thousand people are, in practice, no longer locatable by their own counsel.
- **Germany is preparing to restrict access to its own opposition party's contingency plans because the military fears they would reach Moscow.** Berlin is moving to limit circulation of a 1,000-page 2024 blueprint for a potential AfD government in Saxony-Anhalt, which sets out responses to a further Russian attack in Eastern Europe. The defence ministry says it is assessing what needs protection; an AfD spokesman called withholding intelligence on "unsubstantiated and unprovable allegations" undemocratic. Both characterisations are attributed.
- **Hackers manipulated physical controls at two Colorado water utilities** — altering equipment settings, disabling remote access and alarms, and changing pumping cycles. Each serves fewer than 200 people and officials say service and public safety were unaffected. The attackers are unidentified. The significance is not the scale; it is that the controls moved.
- **Hundreds of thousands of children returned to in-person schooling in Gaza on Saturday for the first time in nearly three years.** UNICEF says 98% of the territory's schools were damaged or destroyed.

15 Appendix — stock cards**MU · MICRON TECHNOLOGY****1,096.16** +5.00%

Cap \$1.238T · range 1,030.02–1,097.25 · closed at 97% of range · FQ4 results 30 Sep

Led the memory complex and closed within a dollar of its high. Plans to roughly double monthly HBM capacity to ~100,000 wafers by year-end. The 30 September print is the single largest scheduled risk to this trade.

SNDK · SANDISK**1,887.04** +6.82%

Cap \$276bn · range 1,756.82–1,909.48 · +0.61% after hours · reported +677% YTD

Rosenblatt initiation at Buy, \$2,400 target, on NAND repricing from commodity to AI infrastructure and contracted volume covering ~65% of FY28 output. A stock up nearly sevenfold this year does not need much to reprice either way.

XLFX · FINANCIAL SELECT SECTOR**54.80** -1.97%

Vol 69.8m — heaviest of any sector · range 54.55–56.05 · opened 56.00 · 6.48% below 52wk high

Worst sector, heaviest volume, opened at the high and closed near the low, on a day yields did not move. This is the market repricing net interest margin for a hiking Fed rather than reacting to anything that happened on Tuesday.

XLU · UTILITIES SELECT SECTOR**40.53** -0.32%

52wk low 40.45 — only 0.20% below · vol 18.9m · down >10% this quarter

Hedgeye's number-one sector-style short, sitting on a 52-week low with elevated volume. In a rising-rate regime the bond proxy is the trade that keeps working; the risk is that everyone now knows it.

CSCO · CISCO SYSTEMS**106.44** -4.50%

Cap \$420bn · range 104.51–110.43 · below 20/50/100-day averages · ~9% above the 200-day

A price-target trim from \$132 to \$125 with an unchanged Neutral rating took 4.5% out of a \$420bn company on a day its own sector rose. That tells you how thin the bid under a well-owned, well-performed name is.

ORCL · ORACLE**149.20** +0.43%Cap \$451bn · 52wk high 322.54 — **53.74% below** · 52wk low 114.50 · range 148.60–153.60

The quietest entry on this page and the loudest fact in the brief. A company that has lost more than half its value from its high, inside an index at a record, while trading up 0.43% on the day. Opened 151.25 and closed on its low.

NVDA · NVIDIA**228.87** +0.66%

Cap \$5.516T · range 226.50–229.98 · 3.2% below 52wk high · Hedgeye: bullish TREND

The largest company in the world moved less than the SOX by 140bp. Alibaba's Zhenwu V900 announcement and the Aivres export allegations both land against its China narrative in summit week.

AMD · ADVANCED MICRO DEVICES**623.77** +1.34%Cap \$1.018T · **high of 624.52 is the 52-week high** · closed 0.12% below it

Crossed \$1 trillion for the first time on Monday and closed Tuesday fractionally below a fresh high. Reported at ~157x earnings and roughly 70% above its 200-day average — priced for the agentic-CPU thesis working.

XLE · ENERGY SELECT SECTOR**61.78** -1.09%Vol 39.3m — second heaviest · band 61.57–65.98, at **4.8%** · 6.63% below 52wk high

Hedgeye bought this as a new asset allocation at twenty-one cents off its risk-range floor, into an Iran de-escalation headline. The position and the catalyst point in opposite directions, which is the point of a defined stop.

SCHW · CHARLES SCHWAB**~100.35** -6.11%

Fifth-largest S&P decliner · not in our capture set — level and change are press-reported

The clearest single expression of the financials problem. Company guidance puts a 25bp fed funds move at \$250–300m of annualised net interest revenue; the Fed has now moved it the unhelpful way for the first time since 2023.

16 About this edition

- **Covers** the US cash session of Tuesday 22 September 2026 as settled, the after-hours tape, the Globex session to capture, and the full Hedgeye evening publication set.
- **Captured** in a single 2.4-second window, **09:10:50-09:10:53 GMT+8**, via `scripts/capture.py`. TradingView returned 96 of 96 instruments; **Yahoo Finance returned 0 of 62 and aborted on its 429 circuit breaker**, so the run is TradingView-single-sourced. Divergences and the recovered manual cross-checks are set out in section 18.
- **Ran 3h 10m late**. The nominal hour is 06:00 GMT+8; this fired at 09:10. Consequences: Tokyo, Seoul and Sydney were already open at capture and Hong Kong opened twenty minutes later, so section 12 is not a pre-open snapshot. Offsetting that, Globex had been open for 3h 10m rather than reopening at the bell, which is why futures rows carry real — if very thin — prints.
- **Settled versus live**. The six cash equity and volatility rows are settled closes from 16:00 ET Tuesday, **5h 11m old** at capture and the stalest rows in the document. Everything else — futures, yields, energy, metals, FX, crypto — is live, with the four index-futures rows carrying a ~10-minute feed delay.
- **Hedgeye edition: FULL**. The logged-in feed loaded first attempt. The live risk-range set is the Early Look of **22 September, 07:26 ET / 19:26 GMT+8**, by **Keith McCullough**, titled "Jail's #Quad2 Squeeze!" — 13h 45m old at capture and **superseded tonight at approximately 19:25 GMT+8**. Also read: the Macro Show Summary Notes for 22 September (10:34 ET), and the Signal Strength Stocks update (11:18 ET, 49 stocks, 7 added — SHEL, U, ILMN, PSX, MPC, VLO, DINO — none removed; note that four of the seven additions are refiners or integrators, which corroborates the new energy allocation).
- **Quad path: NOT PRINTED**. No explicit path notation appeared in either the Early Look or the Macro Show notes. The regime is described throughout as #Quad2. We make no claim about the path and do not treat its absence as evidence of stability.
- **Not available**: the previous session's Early Look, so all risk-range band moves are UNKNOWN; consensus for Wednesday's flash PMIs and the EIA petroleum report; the API crude print; IGV, SCHW and the SOX components, which are outside the capture instrument set.

17 Sources

Prices. TradingView bulk scanner, 96 instruments, 09:10:50-09:10:51 GMT+8; Yahoo Finance attempted 09:10:50-09:10:53 and aborted at 0 of 62 on HTTP 429. Hedgeye risk-range series measured on the instruments Hedgeye names — TVC:GOLD, TVC:SILVER and OANDA:XCUUSD for the metals, NYMEX:CL1! and NYMEX:NG1! for energy.

Hedgeye. The logged-in feed at `app.hedgeye.com`, read 09:12-09:22 GMT+8: the Early Look of 22 September 07:26 ET; the Macro Show Summary Notes of 22 September 10:34 ET, which carry the publisher's own AI-generation caveat; and the Signal Strength Stocks update of 22 September 11:18 ET.

Macro and policy. The Federal Reserve Board and the Federal Reserve Bank of New York for the Williams and Jefferson speeches and the FOMC calendar; the Philadelphia and Richmond Feds for their own September surveys; the University of Michigan for preliminary sentiment; Bloomberg and Investing.com for Barkin's remarks; FXStreet for the Richmond consensus.

Session narrative and single stocks. TheStreet's live blog for Tuesday 22 September; Reuters, AP, CNBC, Benzinga, 24/7 Wall St., TradingKey, Investing.com and Kiplinger; SEC EDGAR and company releases for the KB Home, Worthington and AutoZone results.

Commodities, geopolitics and AI. Reuters and AP wires for Iran, Hormuz, the Xi visit, Ukraine, EU sanctions and Greenland; the IEA, OPEC, Bloomberg and Mining.com on copper; specialist trade press for the silver lease-rate and backwardation material, which is not wire-confirmed; NYT, WSJ, Ars Technica, Politico, the Guardian and OpenAI's own publication for the AI items.

18 Data-confidence

CROSS-CHECKS PASSED

- **Cash-index arithmetic is self-consistent to five decimal places on all six indices**. For each, $\text{close} - \text{change} = \text{prior close}$, and $\text{change} \div \text{prior close}$ reproduces the stated percentage exactly. Worked: S&P $7,764.64 - (-0.06) = 7,764.70$, and $-0.06 \div 7,764.70 = -0.000773\%$, matching the stated -0.0008% . Dow $51,863.69 + 185.14 = 52,048.83$, and $-185.14 \div 52,048.83 = -0.3557\%$, matching. SOX $12,689.82 - 256.65 = 12,433.17$, and $256.65 \div 12,433.17 = +2.0642\%$, matching. Deltas across all six were 0.00000.
- **The futures-to-cash basis check is the strongest validation in this run and it passed cleanly**. ES/SPX $+63.61$ points = $+0.82\%$; YM/DJI $+386.31 = +0.74\%$; RTY/RUT $+20.48 = +0.71\%$. Three independent contracts against three independent cash indices, clustering within an 11bp spread, at a level consistent with a ~4% funding rate to December expiry. A mislabelled settle or a stale cash row would have shown up here as one basis out of line with the other two. None was.
- **Metals spot-versus-futures bases are internally coherent**: gold $+1.040\%$, silver $+1.263\%$, copper $+1.733\%$ — an ascending carry consistent with storage and financing costs by metal, and confirmation that the spot series used for the Hedgeye bands are genuine spot and not mislabelled futures. Reading gold on the COMEX future instead would have placed it at 97.7% of its band rather than 68.5%.

- **Yield-curve arithmetic verified directly rather than inferred:** the 2-year was captured as a cash series (TVC:US02Y, 4.747%) rather than reverse-engineered from Hedgeye's published 10s2s spread. $4.955 - 4.747 = 20.8\text{bp}$, against the ~19bp Hedgeye cited a session earlier — a 1.8bp difference explained by timing, not by a data error.
- **capture.py reconciliation counts: 0 matched within 5bp, 0 minor, 0 divergent, 57 single-sourced.** This is **not** a clean reconciliation. There are no divergent rows to resolve **because no second machine source ran** — Yahoo returned 0 of 62 instruments and tripped its five-consecutive-429 circuit breaker in 2.4 seconds.
- **Manual cross-checks recovered against press copy, and they hold.** The Nasdaq Composite record close, the Dow's -185 points / -0.36% to 51,864 and the flat S&P were independently confirmed in wire and vendor wraps. Tuesday's Treasury closes were confirmed at 10-year 4.959%, 2-year 4.743%, 30-year 5.296% against our 4.955 / 4.747 / 5.295 — all inside half a basis point. Micron's +5.00% to \$1,096.16, SanDisk's \$1,887.04, Western Digital's \$464.60 and Cisco's \$106.44 each matched a second source.

KNOWN CONFLICTS AND WEAK MARKS

- **Asian index day-changes conflict with wire snapshots while the levels agree exactly, so we print levels and withhold changes.** Our capture gives Hang Seng 25,087.76 with a +0.18% change field; a wire snapshot gives 25,087.75 and +1.36%. Shanghai: 3,952.128 and +0.06% against 3,952.13 and +1.03%. Levels agreeing to two decimals while percentages disagree by more than a point means the reference close in one feed is wrong, not the price. Sensex disagrees on the level too — 74,529.08 against a wire's 74,894. ASX 200 at 8,766.5 against a wire's Tuesday 8,731.90 is most likely a live Wednesday print but we cannot prove it. Nikkei 65,018.73 sits within 0.22 points of a wire's Tuesday close, which is either a lagging feed or an implausible coincidence; we treat it as Tuesday's settle.
- **Cisco's decline is reported anywhere between -3.3% and -5.6%** across TradingKey, ad-hoc-news, GuruFocus, MarketBeat and Benzinga. We use -4.50% to \$106.44 from our own capture, corroborated by GuruFocus. The direction and the cause are solid; the second decimal is not.
- **Hedgeye's published Russell 2000 band reads "2834-2825" — floor above ceiling.** That is inverted as printed. We reproduce it verbatim, flag it, and draw no conclusion from it. RUT settled at 2,889.92, above both numbers either way.
- **WTI's level is challenged by one source.** A third-party series showed a 22 September WTI range of roughly 91.30-93.82, inconsistent with our \$90.09. Our figure is NYMEX:CL1! captured live and is internally consistent with its own overnight range of 89.47-90.17; but a rival source disagrees by more than a dollar and the WTI-below-band conclusion rests on eight cents. **That conclusion is fragile and should be treated as such.** Natural gas is similarly challenged: our \$3.025 against a third-party \$2.84.
- **Several headline conclusions rest on a single field.** Oracle's 53.74% drawdown, Utilities' 0.20% above its 52-week low, copper's 0.74% below its high and USD/CNH's 0.08% above its low all derive from TradingView's price_52_week_high/low fields with no second source. The conclusions are robust — these are large, unambiguous distances — but the decimals are not.
- **Schwab's price and change are press-reported only** and outside our capture set, as are the XLF and SOX index levels quoted by third parties. Raymond James is reported at -5.0% by one outlet and -3.6% by another; we quote the range rather than pick.
- **Silver's physical-market narrative is entirely specialist trade press** — lease rates of 7-8%, backwardation, the sixth consecutive annual deficit. No wire confirmation was found for any of it. It is reported as attributed, not as established.
- **October FOMC pricing is given as a range because the primary source was unreachable.** Two third-party proxies gave 56% and 59.7% for a further 25bp; CME's own FedWatch could not be retrieved. The four-point spread is the uncertainty.

KNOWN GAPS

- **The previous session's Early Look could not be reached by any route attempted**, so every risk-range band move — floor, ceiling and width — is **UNKNOWN**. The category feed returns the identical note for page=1, page=2 and per_page=5, and / research/early-look resolves to an error page. This is the single most valuable comparison in section 4 and we do not have it. It is not a statement that the bands were unchanged.
- **Absence of a Hedgeye position change is NOT evidence there was none.** The MOMO Tracker, KM's Top 3, Chart of the Day, Crypto Quant, Capital Allocation Pro and Real-Time Alerts did not appear in the feed index this morning. Those are precisely the publications that would carry an intraday position change, and the Real-Time Alerts stream in particular. Any allocation shift after the 10:34 ET Macro Show is invisible to this edition.
- **No Quad path notation was printed in anything we read.** The path lives in the US Monthly Quad Forecast inside the Macro Week Summary Notes, behind a separate link we did not reach.
- **Consensus figures are missing for every scheduled release in the next three days** — the flash PMIs, jobless claims, new home sales, durable goods — and for the EIA petroleum report, including the API print for the week to 18 September. They are left blank rather than estimated. Note also that the EIA's own weekly summary PDF endpoint is currently serving a stale December 2025 file and must not be quoted as current.
- **It could not be established whether the EU's Russia sanctions renewal cleared before its midnight 22 September expiry.** This is an unresolved, market-relevant item and is flagged as such in section 11 rather than glossed.
- **Same-day drivers were not found** for Applied Materials, Intel, Moderna, Monolithic Power, Celldex, Planet Fitness or the New York Times, and actuals were not found for MillerKnoll or Thor Industries. Earnings dates beyond Micron's and the October FOMC are from secondary calendars and are unconfirmed.

TIMING & UNVERIFIED

- **Capture window: 09:10:50-09:10:53 GMT+8, a spread of 2.4 seconds.** No top-up pass was required, so no row carries a separate capture time. The index-futures rows carry a ~10-minute feed delay and are effectively 09:00.
- **Stalest rows: the six cash equity and volatility closes, 5 hours 11 minutes old at capture.** Next stalest: the Hedgeye risk ranges at 13 hours 45 minutes. Everything else is live to within ten minutes.
- **The run fired 3 hours 10 minutes late.** The most consequential effect is that Tokyo, Seoul and Sydney had been trading for ten to seventy minutes at capture and Hong Kong opened twenty minutes after it. Section 12 is written as an already-open snapshot, not a pre-open one.

- **Overnight change figures are not information and should not be read as such.** ES traded 15,191 lots against a 1,460,188 ten-day average — one per cent; RTY 1,401 against 188,071 — 0.7%. In FX, DXY's entire range since the reopen is 4.8 ticks and EUR/USD's is 5.2 pips. A -0.04% ES "move" on that book is a quote, not a market.
- **Superseded shortly.** Tonight's Early Look publishes at approximately 19:25 GMT+8 and replaces every risk range in section 4. The flash PMIs at 21:45 and the EIA report at 22:30 will move the energy rows. The PBoC fix at 09:15 Beijing — five minutes after this capture — will have moved USD/CNH before this is read.
- **Verify live prices before acting on anything in this document.** Every level here is a photograph taken at 09:10:50 GMT+8 on a single data source, and several of the conclusions drawn from it turn on margins of a few cents.